

Naming My Feelings

Teacher Guide • Topic 1 of 12 • Value: Respectful



At a glance	
Goal	Students name four feelings (happy, sad, mad, worried), notice one body clue for each, and say “I feel ____.”
Time	15 minutes in Morning Meeting, in place of the general lesson. Centers run during the week.
When	Teach first in the toolkit, early in the year. Every later topic uses these feeling words.
In the bundle	Student deck (7 slides, press N for notes) • Poster (letter and 11×17) • Center kit (sort, sequence, act it out, desk strips, coloring) • Mini book • Family half-sheet
Words we use	“Every feeling has a name.” • “I notice my body. I name my feeling.” • “I feel ____.”

Before you teach

- Hang the poster at child height near your meeting space or the calm corner. Students point to it all week.
- All feelings are okay. Say “feels good” and “feels hard,” never “good feelings” and “bad feelings.”
- Never ask a student to name a feeling in front of the class that they did not choose to share. Check in privately instead.
- Tape a desk strip at the table of any student who needs the feeling faces close by.
- Pair students who need support with a steady turn-and-talk partner before the lesson starts.

The lesson, slide by slide

The same script is in the deck’s presenter notes. Press N while presenting.

Slide	Say and do	Look for	Engagement move
1 • Title & Promise (R2)	Make a happy face, then a sad face. “Our faces and bodies tell us how we feel. Every feeling has a name.” Say together: “Every feeling has a name.”	Students copy your faces and repeat the line.	Equity stick: “Show me a happy face.”

Slide	Say and do	Look for	Engagement move
2 • Get Calm First (R1)	Do it with them. “Smell the flower. Blow out the candle. Long and slow. Three times.” Then ask, “How does your body feel now?”	Exhale longer than inhale; shoulders drop.	LiveSchool point: “You breathed slow three times.”
3 • What Did Lee Do? (R2, R3)	Point to each picture. “It was Lee’s turn to read. Her tummy felt funny. She noticed her body. She named it: ‘I feel worried.’ She told her teacher, and she felt better.” Class says: “I notice my body. I name my feeling.”	Students follow the pictures; whole class repeats the line.	Equity stick: “Which picture shows Lee naming her feeling? Point.”
4 • Turn and Talk (R3, R4)	Model knee to knee. “Look at Lee. Tell your partner: Lee feels ____.” 30 seconds, then ask one pair, “How did you know?”	Partners take turns; some name a body clue.	Equity stick: two shares. Praise the clue they noticed.
5 • Watch Me, Then Show Me (R3, R4, R5)	Read: “My friend gives me a high five. I feel...” A student shows the face and says, “I feel happy.” Repeat with “My tower falls down” and “It is my turn to read out loud.” Then everyone shows all four faces.	Students use the full sentence; class names the clue.	LiveSchool point for the full sentence.
6 • My Promise Today (R2, R5)	Hand on heart. “Say it with me: I can name my feeling.” Then: “Point to how you feel right now.”	Every student says the promise and points to one face.	Equity stick: three names. Pointing counts.
7 • How We Leave (R1, R4, R5)	“Stand up. Calm face. Walk. Ready to learn.” Do not time this at K-2.	Calm bodies while moving; calm walking.	LiveSchool point for the table that walks with calm bodies the whole way.

Practice bridges for slide 5

Students model, not the teacher. The teacher narrates and asks the class what they saw.

If the model is...	Say
Excellent	“Show the class again. Everyone, what feeling was that? What clue did you see?”
Partly right	“You showed the face. Now say the sentence: I feel ____.”
Silly	“Thank you. Let’s see it the calm way.” Call a new student. No commentary.

Centers

Print one kit per group. Laminate the mats and cards so they last. Students work in groups of 2 to 4.

Center	Set up	Read to students	Done looks like
Sort It	Sort mat (landscape page) and 8 cut picture cards.	"Look at each picture. Does it feel good or feel hard? Put it on the side where it goes."	4 cards on Feels good, 4 on Feels hard. Accept any sort a student can explain.
Put It in Order	Sequencing mat and 4 cut cards.	"Put Lee's story in order: first, next, then, last. Tell your partner the story."	Students retell: big feeling, notice, name it, feel better.
Act It Out	4 role-play cards in a stack.	"Pick a card. Read it with me. Show the face. Say: I feel ____."	Each student shows a face and says the sentence.
Feeling Clues	Desk strips, one per student.	"Point to each face. Say the feeling and the clue."	Each student names all four feelings.
Color	Coloring page and crayons.	"Color Lee. In the box, draw your face. How do you feel today?"	A face drawing and a feeling word, said or written.

Answer keys

- **Sort, Feels good:** friends building with blocks • Kiara's high five • Lee reading proudly • Tee and Nadege doing a puzzle.
- **Sort, Feels hard:** Nadege gets hurt • Tee's tower falls • Tee finds the work too hard • Lee waits to read, worried.
- **Put It in Order:** 1 Lee feels worried in the reading circle • 2 Lee notices her body • 3 Lee tells her teacher • 4 Lee reads and feels proud.

The mini book (one child, Tier 2)

- For a child who needs extra practice with feeling words: one who shuts down, says "fine" to everything, or acts feelings out instead of saying them.
- Read it one-on-one at a calm time. Make each face together and touch the body clue.
- Read it every day for a week. Let the child turn the pages and point to the faces.
- On the back, the child colors a star each day they name a feeling. Celebrate every star.

When naming feelings gets tricky

Follows the Responsive Behavior Plan: the adult response is the intervention. Fewer words as escalation rises.

1. **A student cannot find the word.** Offer two faces: “Do you feel mad or worried?” Pointing counts.
2. **A student says “fine” to everything.** Name what you see, gently: “Your fists look tight. Maybe mad?” Then wait.
3. **A student is too upset to talk.** Do not ask for words yet. Get calm first: breathe together or offer the calm corner. Name the feeling later.
4. **A student names a feeling about home or someone hurting them.** Listen, thank them, and follow your school’s reporting steps. Tell the counseling team the same day.
5. **A student names mad and then acts unsafe.** Safety first. Use Topic 7, Gentle Hands, and the Responsive Behavior Plan.

Next in the toolkit: Topic 2, Using the Calm Corner, and Topic 3, Belly Breathing.

Family connection

- Send the family half-sheet home the day you teach. It is in English, Spanish, and Haitian Creole.